Howbridge Infant School

Gender Policy

September 2025

The General Duty
The aim of this policy is to ensure that Howbridge Infant School promotes equality of opportunity amongst all staff and pupils.

It is our duty to give due regard to the need:

- To eliminate unlawful discrimination and harassment;
- To promote equality of opportunity between all genders.

It applies to all members of the school community and in conjunction with all the school's equality policies and procedures, is central in meeting our school aims.

The policy clarifies the role that the school has in demonstrating gender equality and fairness in all aspects of its work. This includes:

- policy making;
- the treatment of pupils;
- treating all genders equitably through our employment practices such as recruitment, training, promotion and flexible working.

We understand that in some circumstances identical treatment will not always be appropriate to tackle gender inequality. It is important that all individuals have the very best opportunities regardless of gender.

Specific Duties
To ensure there are no major equality issues in our school's functions and services we will:

- Review school policies and practices to assess the ways in which they might impact on gender equality;
- Ensure governors, staff, pupils, parents and others in our school are accountable and understand their responsibilities with regard to preventing discrimination and harassment and promoting gender equality;
- Assess and address the causes of any gender pay gap;
- Review and revise this policy annually.

Responsibilities
Responsibility for promoting and managing equality and diversity within the school rests with the Governing Body.

The Head Teacher is responsible for the day to day management issues. All members of the school community will have responsibility for following policy and promoting gender equality. The school will also work in partnership with others, for example, the Local Authority and its Human Resources Department for personnel related issues.

All staff have a responsibility to deal with incidents of sexual harassment or bullying; help eliminate unlawful discrimination; prepare and/or help deliver a curriculum, learning and teaching methods, classroom organisation and assessment procedures, behaviour management and extended school activities (including work with parents) that take account of the need to eliminate unlawful discrimination and harassment and promote gender equality.

Pupils and parents have a proportionate responsibility to understand and act in accordance with the policy, as do **visitors** to the school.

Infringements of the Gender Equality Policy
Any intentional infringement of the policy is treated as a serious matter.

Where possible, breaches of the policy will be dealt with in a manner appropriate to the level of the breach, and with the intention of bringing about the relevant changes. More serious infringements will be dealt with in accordance with our anti-bullying and behaviour procedures, and the disciplinary procedures for staff.

Unintentional infringement of the policy will also be dealt with in an appropriate manner, and steps taken to re-educate those involved to prevent future infringements.

Where safeguarding issues based on sex and gender come to the attention of the school these will be dealt with according to our child protection procedures.

Monitoring the Policy

The policy, along with any associated codes of practice and procedures, will be subject to regular review to ensure that the school's commitment to promoting and managing equality and diversity is actively pursued to meet its Gender Equality Duty.

Date of next review: Autumn 2026